

*By Hannah Ramsey, Latoya Allen, Rachel Hoard,
Stirling Peebles, Jesse Riddle and Jaclyn Camden*

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What is a higher education program for students with intellectual disability?

A college program where students take courses, do career development activities, and enjoy campus life while earning a certificate or credential at a 4-year and 2-year institute of higher education.

2

Why would a student with intellectual disability pursue higher education?

Students with intellectual disability deserve the choice and dignity in the option to attend college. Higher education programs support students as they work toward a credential and give students knowledge, skills, and experience get a job or career.

Students with intellectual disability who attend higher education programs are more likely to obtain and maintain employment after graduation.

3

What does the student with intellectual disability gain from going to college?

A wide variety of skills and invaluable experiences in and out of the classroom. Students will learn workplace readiness skills, independence, decision-making skills, social skills, personal responsibility, and more.

4

How does attending college help students with intellectual disability prepare for gainful employment?

Programs give opportunities for students to explore interests and gain hands-on experiences through work-based learning, internships, or paid employment. College holds students to a higher standard than they may be used to, which encourages student growth.

More than half of students with intellectual disability leaving high school have never had a work experience.

5

Is higher education employment-related?

Yes! The goal of these programs is to prepare students for competitive integrated employment postgraduation. Students receive individualized supports to do academic coursework and career development activities like internships, paid employment, resume development, and professional networking.

6

What comparable benefits are available to support students in accessing/attending?

Some programs are [Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Programs](#), which allow students to access federal financial aid options like Pell Grants. Other disability service providers, such as Community Services Boards and Medicaid waiver facilitators, can help financially support students through college.

Take a look through [Think College's resources on Paying for College](#) for more information!

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What certificate/degree do students receive after graduating?

Certificates of program completion, industry-recognized certificates and credentials, college certificates and badges, and more! While most students are not earning a degree, they are still gaining valuable skills, opportunities, and useful credentials.

Check out Think College's page on [Student Credentials](#) for more information!

8

What does it mean if a program is accredited?

Accreditation gives quality benchmarks that help students and their families identify high-quality higher education programs. Accreditation is a newer process, so just because a program is not yet accredited does not mean that it is not of high quality!

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What can I do to support my client in a higher education program for students with intellectual disability?

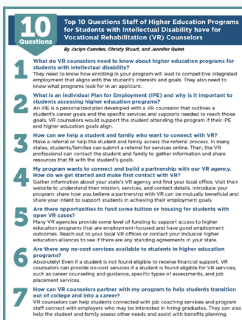
You play an important role in connecting clients who have an interest in college as a pathway to employment to programs in your state or across the country. Be involved! Join team meetings, keep in touch with the student, and share resources and expertise.

Take a look at Think College's [College Search](#) resource to find the higher education programs in your area!

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What additional resources can I provide to students in these programs?

Financial support, like tuition and program fee support, meal plans, books, assistive technology, and transportation as well as other services like pre-employment transition services, benefits planning, and travel training!



Read the "Top 10 Questions Staff of Higher Education Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability have for Vocational Rehabilitation (VR) Counselors"



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